

New campaign offers patients green shoots of recovery

Wednesday, 1 August 2018

Just 10 days in a hospital bed can leave some older patients so weak they will lose the ability to look after themselves independently.

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So while a medical issue might have been solved during their stay, they could be left with a legacy of problems including not being able to walk to the toilet or even make a cup of tea.

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This is why physiotherapists at Gorseinon Hospital in Swansea are part of a new campaign to get patients moving as soon as it's safe.

But traditional exercise programmes are not the only option for a very important reason.

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"As physiotherapists we are synonymous with delivering exercise programmes," said community physiotherapist Catrin Treharne.



- **"But people are more likely to engage in an activity than an exercise programme."**

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Staff and patients are now taking part in the Love Activity Hate Exercise? campaign from the Chartered Society of Physiotherapy, which designed the programme to counter the negative feelings some people have about exercise.

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A successor campaign to #EndPJparalysis - designed to get patients up, dressed and moving - Love Activity Hate Exercise? and the physiotherapists delivering it want to find the activities that will grab patients' interest and keep them motivated.

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Patient suggestions have now led to alternative activities being organised within the 36-bed hospital, which provides assessment and reablement for mainly older patients admitted following falls, fractures or surgery in Morriston and Singleton hospitals.

Above: Patient Rita Clarke helps brighten up the raised bed by planting a geranium

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These range from doing a puzzle, to exercise to music classes, to gardening.

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The idea is simple: patients who are up, dressed, active and engaging with staff and each other will get better quicker and will return home stronger and more able to look after themselves.

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"We want to get them out of their bays and out of the hospital mentality," said Catrin.

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"Patients can lose their routine and their sense of themselves while they are in hospital.

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"And if they stay in bed for longer than 72 hours their muscles start to weaken. After 10 days patients are completely deconditioned. They will have lost strength throughout their body. That could make a difference between them being up and active before to not being able to get out of bed. It affects some people so much that they can't get to the chair or get to the toilet.

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"The benefits of activity for the patient are that it keeps them healthier for longer, they have a better quality of life and are less reliant on the NHS and care workers."

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Margaret Davies, 84, from Swansea, is among the patients who have started looking after the hospital garden as part of Love Activity Hate Exercise?



Left: Physiotherapist Catrin Treharne and patient Margaret Davies plant a celosia

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Previously mobile, she has had a long hospital stay following an operation on her spine and is currently using a wheelchair.

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"I was living independently before and I want to get back to that," she said.

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"I didn't have carers or anything, but my family is very good.

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"This campaign is good because it gets you out of the ward where it can be very boring."

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Rita Clarke, 63, from Swansea, suffers from chronic conditions and has had her left leg amputated due to ulcers.

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But the keen gardener, who has grown fruit, veg and flowers all her life, is determined to retain her independence and has seized the opportunity to help out in the garden.

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"If I am able to do an activity, I will do it. Gardening is my first choice," she said.

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"I am very determined. I won't let anything stand in my way."

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The gardening group, who work from their wheelchairs, has weeded the large raised bed in the

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hospital garden and planted geraniums and celosia to add a splash of colour.

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The work has given Ernest Harris, 72, the first chance to get outside in four months.

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"This is the first time I have been out since the end of March," he said.

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"I've gardened all my life. It was my hobby."

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Isobel Morgan, 73, added: **"On a beautiful day there's nothing that we can appreciate more than a garden full of flowers."**

Catrin explained that support for patients does not stop once they leave hospital.

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"There is an outreach service with the community physiotherapy service because while they might have practised getting up a step in hospital, they haven't tried their step at home, so we will go out and support them to do that.

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Right: The Gorseinon Hospital gardening group with staff

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"We are saying to people that they don't need to be in hospital to get better, you will do better in your own home and we can do that in a supportive way."

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Love Activity Hate Exercise? is due to run until October 1,

which is the International Day of Older Persons.



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Hftnk61szOo>

Source: Abertawe Bro Morgannwg University Health Board



Call for Applications

Augsburg-Munich International Doctoral Program

~~Rethinking Environment: The Environmental Humanities and the Ecological Transformation of Society~~

Deadline: January 31, 2025

The University of Augsburg and Ludwig-Maximilian University of Munich invite applications for

~~12 Doctoral Positions (m/f/d)~~

~~in their International Doctoral Program (IDK) funded by the Elite Network of Bavaria. The positions are to be filled for 65 % of regular working hours in an employment relationship initially limited to two years, with the option of extending the temporary employment for an additional two years, provided that the relevant requirements are met. If the personal and pay scale requirements are met, remuneration will be in accordance with pay group E 13 TV L. The IDK starts on October 1, 2025.~~

~~Based at the University of Augsburg (Environmental Science Center, WZU) and Ludwig-Maximilian University of Munich (Rachel Carson Center, RCC), this Environmental Humanities program offers a unique opportunity to pursue a doctoral degree in an international and interdisciplinary setting and under the supervision of faculty from both universities. We are looking for applications from fields such as American Studies, Anthropology, Communication Science, Environmental Economics, Environmental Ethics, Geography Education, History, Human Geography, Iberian & Latin American Studies, Philosophy, and Theology.~~

~~Under the IDK's broad theme "Rethinking Environment. The Environmental Humanities and the Ecological Transformation of Society" we invite projects working on a variety of scales ranging from the global to the local that align with the program's focus on socio-ecological transformation. We particularly welcome topics that relate, but are not exclusive to:~~

- ~~• Landscapes, Resources, and Infrastructures~~
- ~~• Environmental Education and Communication~~
- ~~• Environmental Knowledges and Justice~~
- ~~• Environmental Narratives and Representations~~

~~We invite research on all world regions and applications from across the world. Languages are English and German; non-native speakers are expected to acquire a working level of German within the first two years of the program. The IDK is looking for candidates willing to engage in interdisciplinary dialogue. Active participation in the program and residency in the region are expected.~~

~~Applicants must have a completed degree (M.A., M.Sc. or equivalent) with very good grades. Submissions can be made via our online application form and need to include:~~

- ~~• The filled-out online application form~~
- ~~• a letter of motivation (400 words max.)~~
- ~~• a project proposal (max. 1500 words, including abstract)~~
- ~~• a short CV (max. 2 pages)~~
- ~~• copies of university degree(s)~~
- ~~• final thesis or other single-authored text (e.g. term paper, peer-reviewed article, book chapter)~~

~~Reflecting the participating universities' commitment to diversity, we encourage applications from underrepresented groups and regions. We especially welcome applications from women and LGBTQI+ persons, and explicitly invite people with chronic illnesses and disabilities to apply. Our universities stand up for compatibility of family and professional life. In the case of equally qualified candidates, applicants with a disability/chronic health condition will be given preference. For more information see <https://www.uni-augsburg.de/de/verantwortung/gender-equity-diversity/> and <https://www.lmu.de/de/die-lmu/arbeiten-an-der-lmu/zusaetzliche-angebote/diversity/>~~

~~The application may be written in English or German and must be submitted as one PDF file (up to 8 MB) via our application form at~~

~~<https://www.uni-augsburg.de/en/forschung/einrichtungen/institute/wzu/studium/idk/application24/>~~

~~The application form, along with a list of FAQs, can also be found here: <https://www.uni-augsburg.de/de/forschung/einrichtungen/institute/wzu/studium/idk/>~~

~~The Deadline is January 31, 2025.~~

~~Preselected candidates will be invited for individual interviews starting March 2025.~~

~~More information on the program, advisory team, research topics of the first cohort can be found on our website <https://rethinking-environment-idk.de/>~~

~~For questions please contact: PD-Dr. Kirsten Twelbeck (twelbeck.idk@wzu.uni-augsburg.de)~~

~~Please note that only the German version of the job advertisement is legally binding. It can be found on the website: <https://www.uni-augsburg.de/de/jobs-und-karriere/stellenangebote>. This English translation of the job advertisement is provided to help you understand the original German one.~~